

HIGH SCHOOLS

Olmsted Falls hands Rocky River its first loss

By DICK ZUNT

PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

Visiting Olmsted Falls started fast and surged at the end to topple Rocky River, 65-55, in an electric Southwestern Conference basketball game last night.

The victory improved Olmsted Falls to 3-0 in the conference and left the Pirates at 2-1.

Overall, both schools are 4-1.

Two-time defending champion Olmsted Falls, which has won 33 SWC games in a row and 40 straight against conference oppo-

nents, including tournament play, shot to an 6-0 lead in the first 4½ minutes.

Rocky River called a 20-second timeout after the first three Olmsted Falls field goals.

When play resumed, things did not get any better for the Pirates, who got behind, 8-0, and trailed, 15-5 at the end of the first quarter.

Rocky River missed its first seven shots and turned the ball over four times in the first four minutes.

The Bulldogs hounded the Pirates on defense and continued to climb the backboards on their

way to a 25-7 lead, after a driving layup by 6-3 freshman Mike Ganzey, with 4:22 left in the second quarter.

Rocky River then outscored Olmsted Falls, 11-4, behind the scoring of 6-4 junior Mike Woodward (five points) and 3-point field goals by junior John Caruso and senior Matt Ferguson.

Olmsted Falls took a 29-18 lead at halftime, with Gansey scoring on a tip-in just before time ran out.

Woodward and 6-4 senior Sean Kennedy scored the first two field goals of the third quarter but the Bulldogs managed to stay ahead and take a 41-38 lead into the

fourth quarter.

With Kennedy scoring all 11 of his points in the second half, Rocky River three times climbed within one point, but the defending champions never let them get over the hump.

A 3-pointer from the left corner by Kennedy with 3:20 left pulled the Pirates to 50-49, but Olmsted Falls sophomore guard Manzie Williams stole the ball on a long pass and sank a short jumper and the Bulldogs led by at least three points the rest of the way.

Gansey and junior Sean Radigan each scored 18 points and Williams finished with 13 for Olmsted Falls. Radigan sank

eight straight free throws in the fourth quarter and finished 10-of-11 for the game as the Bulldogs converted 22 of 29 free throws.

Caruso led Rocky River with 15 points and Kennedy and Woodward each finished with 11.

"Obviously, this ia a gigantic win," said Olmsted Falls coach Pat Donahue.

"We're a young team so we have to play hard," said Donahue. "We've stressed defense from Day One in practice. We don't have the big scorers we've had in the past, so we have to play defense until we find the guy who scores."

"We played the first half with a

lot of emotion. I'm pleased with everybody we put on the floor. The kids don't want our streak to end and responded."

Said Rocky River coach Jim Rucki: "They took it to us right from the beginning of the game. I don't know what to say."

"We just could not get over the hump. We should not have put ourselves in a position where we had to play perfect basketball to come back."

"They [Olmsted Falls] had tremendous hustle in the first half, they came to play."

Rocky River sank seven 3-pointers, with Caruso sinking three and Jeff Peate two.

Division III teams rule Lewis meet

By BOB MIGRA

PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

If the Mike Lewis Invitational wrestling tournament yesterday is any indication, it looks like it

will be a very interesting season in Division III in Northeast Ohio.

Black River, Wellington and Columbia — all Division III teams — finished 1-2-3 in the eight-team tournament that is usually dominated by Division I and II schools.

The Black River Pirates won five championships and went 9-1 in the final round to finish with 181½ points, winning for the first time at Buckeye.

"That was the best finals that I have ever coached," Black River coach David Khoury said. "We beat some very good kids."

Black River had never finished higher than third.

"Our philosophy has always been to go easy in December," Khoury said. "But with this group, there is no easy month. This is a huge win for us. Hopefully, they can keep it up."

Jason Gebura (112 pounds), Matt Dwyer (130), Ken Goble (160), Mitch Whitesel (189) and heavyweight Kevin Hadlock won championships for the Pirates.

Hadlock, who wrestled at 215 pounds last season, pinned Wellington's Keith Dawson, a state qualifier, in 1:18 in the championship match.

Columbia got championships from Chandley Lambert (135) and Grant Morgan (171).

Morgan, a two-time state qualifier, trailed Buckeye's John Barniak, 5-0, after one period but came back with a second-period pin, in 3:40.

The Raiders had 11 place-winners and finished with 144½ points for their best finish in the tournament.

"Our kids wrestled well," Columbia coach Merle Dusek said. "We're starting to get healthy, al-

though we still have a couple of starters out. We're happy with second place. There were a lot of really nice wrestlers here."

Wellington had four champions and finished with 141½ points.

The Dukes could have finished second, but 10 team points were deducted when 119-pounder Chris Ketchum was disqualified for unsportsmanlike conduct in his third-place match with Buckeye's Travis Moody.

"It was an unfortunate situation," Wellington coach John Sedlick said. "He lost his temper. He knows he was wrong, and hopefully, he learned a lesson."

The Dukes got consecutive championships from Matt Bradstock (140), Marc Jameyson (145) and Dave Charles (152). Ryan Myers gave Wellington its final championship at 215.

Bradstock scored a takedown and added back points in the final minute of an 8-5 victory over Avon Lake's Tim Teets.

Jameyson, a state place-winner, scored an escape to open the third period of a 1-0 victory over Avon Lake's Brian Carbaugh in the finals.

It was the first defeat of the season for Carbaugh, a champion in the Knights of Columbus Invitational last week.

"We wrestled pretty well," Sedlick said. "It's going to be a tough year in Division III."

Buckeye finished fourth, with 135½ points. Alex Cooper became the second four-time champion in the tournament, overpowering his opponents in a very tough 125-pound weight class.

Cooper defeated Columbia state place-winner Josh Richards, 14-2, in the semifinals, and Black River's Joe Hughes, a state runner-up, 5-0, in the finals.

"It feels really good," Cooper said. "I was nervous coming into the finals. It was a very tough weight class. I wasn't too sure about Joe. He placed second in the state and beat a kid I lost to last year."

Strongsville flexes muscles in sweep

By PAT GALBINCEA

PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

It's going to take one heckuva wrestling team to beat Strongsville in a dual meet.

That was firmly established yesterday at the fourth Strongsville Quad, where the host Mustangs whipped Valley Forge, 48-11; North Olmsted, 55-10; and Eastlake North,

40-29.

Eastlake North's Rangers have one of the premier teams in Northeast Ohio, but they didn't have the overall firepower of Strongsville, which is 5-0 on the season.

Eastlake North (2-1) did beat North Olmsted, 40-20, and Valley Forge, 37-32.

The Patriots (2-2) managed a 53-11 victory over North Olmsted (1-6).

"We got better as the day went on," Patriots coach Pat Semary said. "I was pleased, but Strongsville has always had our number. We're not bad, but they are really solid this year."

Two of the area's better 140-pounders battled in the Mustangs-Patriots match, and Strongsville's Jonathon Sawyer emerged with an 8-6 victory over Jon Tarnai.

Tarnai almost pinned Sawyer with a half-nelson in the first period and had a 5-0 lead. Sawyer took down Tarnai to his back in the second period and took an 8-5 lead. A third-period escape by Tarnai made the score 8-6, but Sawyer had to fight off a single-leg takedown effort by the Valley Forge wrestler in the last 25 seconds.

As good as those two wrestlers were, the best 140 pounder on the mat was North Olmsted senior Dan DiSalvo.

An unheralded wrestler, DiSalvo won all three matches with a technical fall and two major decisions. He has exceptional bal-

ance, strong hips and a slithery style that should earn him a trip to the state tournament.

The move of the day was produced by Strongsville heavyweight Aaron Puma against Joe Olzsweski of Valley Forge.

Olzsweski had an 8-5 lead when Puma caught him in a fireman's carry — an unusual maneuver for a 245-pound wrestler — and pinned him with a half-nelson at 2:42.

Mustangs wrestlers who went 3-0 in the quad were Puma, Chris Leidich (130), Timm Januszewski (152) and Andy Cooper (215).

"This is a good group of kids," Mustangs coach Steve Cika said.

"We're fortunate we have no bad wrestlers. I believe we can win the Pioneer Conference, and I know how good Brecksville is."

Eastlake North, which had unbeaten wrestlers in Ray Sabin (103), Ryan Byers (112), Mike Burich (119), Steve Micioc (160), and brothers James (135) and Matt Osolin (189), had an outside chance to beat the Mustangs.

The Mustangs led, 34-29, going into the heavyweight match, which meant Rangers inexperienced 270-pounder Jason Ellis had to pin Puma to win the meet.

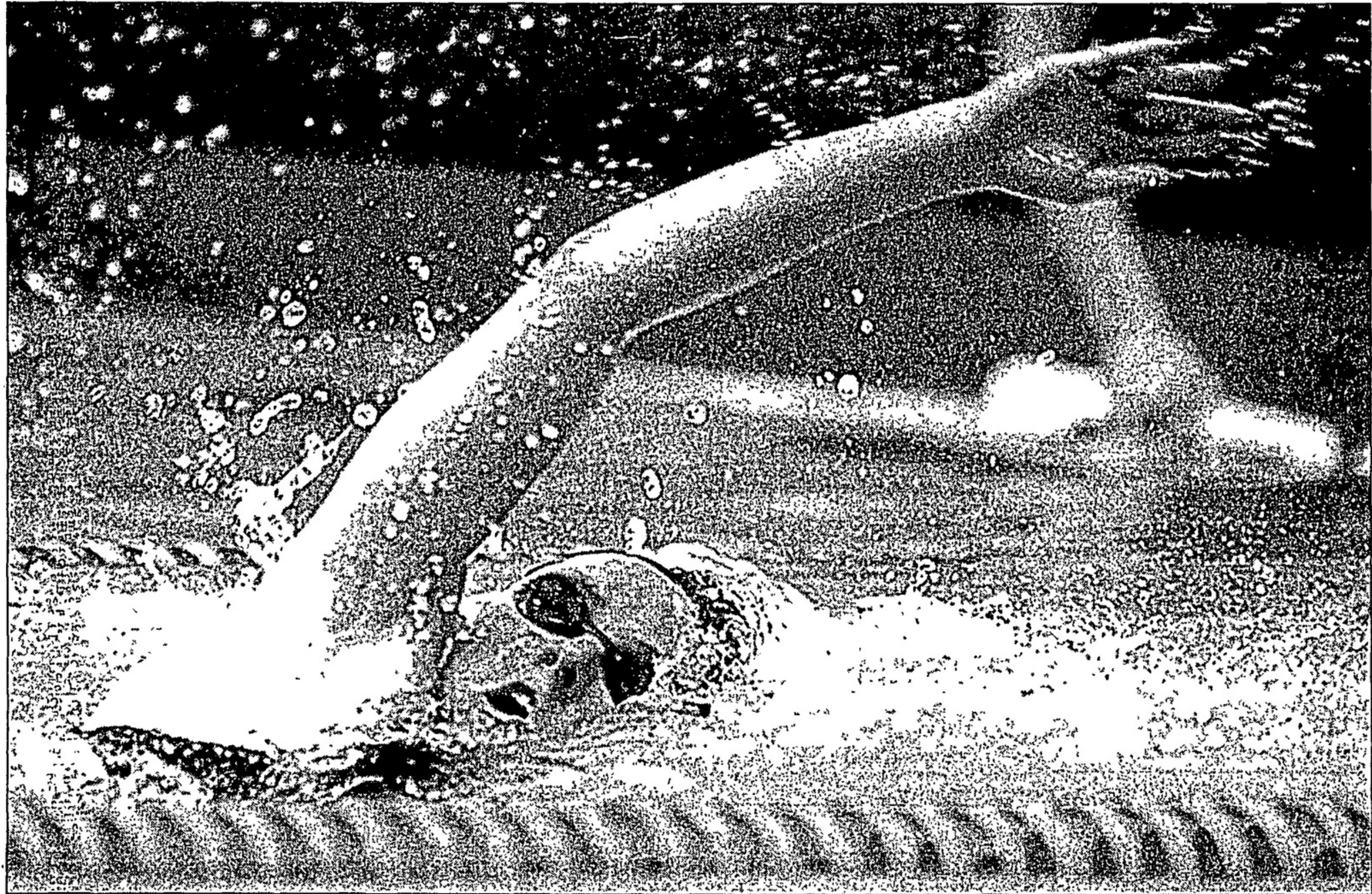
Rangers coach Mike Kokitka opted to use Rick Wiggins, who weighed in at 201 pounds.

Cika called referee Don Wey and noted Wiggins' weight. With the 215-pound class created four years ago, a heavyweight must weigh a minimum of 210 pounds. The previous limit was 188.

Puma won the match by forfeit because Wiggins stepped onto the mat first.

"It was a mistake on my part," Kokitka said. "I never thought we would get this close to Strongsville to begin with."

"I have five outstanding wrestlers, but also some inexperienced weights. Dual meets are really not our strength. Strongsville doesn't have a bad wrestler at any weight."



MIKE LEVY / PLAIN DEALER PHOTOGRAPHER

Chagrin Falls' Diana Munz makes her way through the water en route to the title in the 500-yard freestyle in the Viking Swim Invitational last night.

Sophomore Munz makes big splash

MUNZ FROM 1-C

Munz's record-breaking time not only slightly missed her pool record of 4:50.02, but bested Rose, who touched at 4:56.21.

"I was more interested in seeing how I would swim the race than breaking the record," Munz said. "It was more like a test to me."

Munz showed her usual fast start by taking a 10-yard lead over Rose after 75 yards, and Munz got stronger as the race progressed.

"I just didn't get out fast enough," said Rose, who finished third in the 800-meter free at the U.S. Open.

"I have to get out faster, then hold it the rest of the way."

Another sophomore who made his presence felt was Firestone's Mark Gangloff.

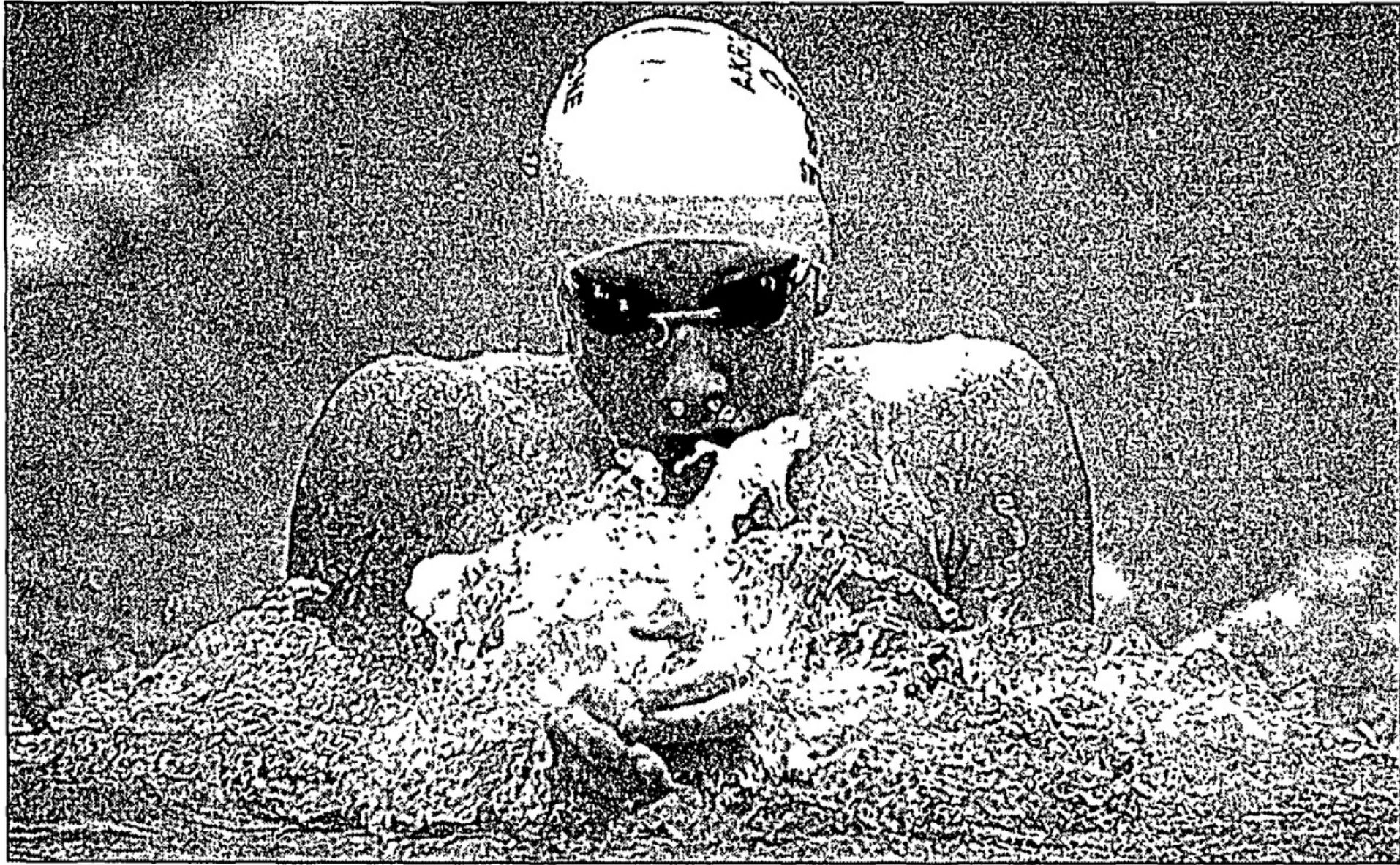
Gangloff, who set the meet record in the 100-yard breaststroke in the preliminaries with a time of 57.41, set the standard in the 200-yard individual medley last night by clocking 1:54.30.

"I felt pretty comfortable in the morning (in the IM), so I went after the record in the finals," Gangloff said. "I didn't save anything for the breaststroke."

Gangloff began to pull away from the field in the third leg of the IM, the breaststroke.

"It was during the breaststroke I felt I had enough to break the record," he said.

Gangloff, who said he was out to break his breaststroke mark in the finals, fell short when he swam 57.43.



MIKE LEVY / PLAIN DEALER PHOTOGRAPHER

Firestone's Mark Gangloff swims the breaststroke during his victory in the 200 individual medley.

Junior Jim Pullin of Hawken shattered the 500-yard freestyle record to lead a 1-2-3 sweep by the Hawks.

Pullin showed why he's the defending state champion by clocking in 4:34.48 to beat freshman Paul Kirk and senior David Krahe, who swam 4:40.18 and 4:43.52, respectively.

Two juniors, Josie Jedick of Rocky River and Erin Abbey of

Mayfield, were double winners.

Jedick swam a lifetime-best 2:07.98 to win the 200-yard individual medley, and won the 100-yard breaststroke in 1:05.24.

Jedick took an early lead in the opening leg, the butterfly, and devastated the field in the breaststroke leg to win the IM and beat Rose, who swam 2:08.96.

Abbey took first in the 50-yard free and 100-yard backstroke.

A volleyball player in the fall, Abbey topped the field in the 50 with 24.47 before heading the backstroke field in 57.88.

In boys diving, University School junior Thatcher Carr surprised nobody by prevailing with \$59.10 points.

Wadsworth sophomore Susan Over captured the girls competition with 443.20 points.

St. Edward tops Padua in semifinal

By DON FRIEDMAN

PLAIN DEALER REPORTER

There have been some great St. Edward-Padua hockey games.

The Eagles' 5-2 victory over Padua in the semifinals of the

27th annual Thornton Park Tournament last night was not one of the better

ones.

St. Edward coach Bob Whidden said "one of the reasons was the Thornton Park rink, which is one of the smaller ones in the area."

"This is a tough rink for the type of teams Doug [Padua coach Doug Hauser] and I have," Whidden said. "You have to drop the puck into the other end of the ice and then chase it. It is not really well-suited to our game."

Regardless of the artistry, the Eagles advanced to the champi-

onship game tonight at 7:30 against Bowling Green. The Bobcats defeated Shaker Heights, 3-2, in overtime in the second semifinal last night.

The title game of this oldest area tournament will follow the 5 p.m. consolation game between St. Ignatius and Cleveland Heights.

The Wildcats earned their way into the consolation final with a 3-2 victory over University School. Cleveland Heights advanced by outlasting Trinity, 6-4.

St. Edward and Padua opened with a bang. Seven seconds after the opening face-off, Bruins freshman Dave Ondt tapped the puck past St. Edward goaltender Bobby Povtal.

It was not an indication of things to come.

The Eagles scored the next two goals, the first by senior forward

Rob Drago at 6:09. Senior forward Ed Difiore gave the Eagles a 2-1 lead on a power play goal at 11:28.

Although he was called on to make eight saves in the period, Padua goaltender Billy Ferkol was constantly surrounded by Eagles.

The teams scored a goal apiece in the second period. Padua senior forward Todd Eckstrand tied the score on another power play at 3:29 of the second period. Difiore came back with what turned out to be the game-winner, a short-handed goal at 6:39 of the second.

The Eagles wrapped it up with two third-period goals by junior forward Lou Fritz at 7:13 and junior forward Todd Krepp at 10:46. Difiore assisted on Fritz's goal.

"It was hard-fought hockey," Whidden said.

Difiore had another way to look at the victory.

"It was a must-win game for us," he said. "We had a bad weekend last week. We lost to St. Ignatius on Saturday and to Meadville on Sunday. So, this was an important game."

"I think our penalty killers did a good job. I thought it was an exciting game."

Trinity took a 2-0 lead over Cleveland Heights in the first period of its consolation game. Dan Cross-Call and Joe Ross, Heights freshmen, scored in the second period to tie the game.

The Tigers led, 3-2, after two periods, but Trinity was ahead, 4-3, with nine minutes left in the game.

Trinity senior captain Paul Ovev is thought to have suffered a broken wrist in the first period.

In the other consolation game, junior forward Mike Beach scored two goals to lead St. Ignatius' victory.